# Chapter 6: Content Framework

*Study Guide, based on Mastering the TOGAF Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 6 (pp. 111-126)*

## Overview

Chapter 6 (pp. 111-126) explains the **Content Framework**, best thought of as a *categorization framework* that structures the architecture's work products and models and maps them to the ADM phases (p. 111). Section 6.1 places it alongside the Enterprise Metamodel and lists its five purposes (pp. 111-114). Section 6.2 lists its advantages in the current Standard: modular, core and extended content models, artifacts, views and viewpoints, agile alignment, tailoring guidance, outcome focus (pp. 114-117). Section 6.3 maps its sections to the ADM phases and explains the **Extended Content Framework** (pp. 117-122). Section 6.4 shows how the ADM refines the framework over time, with a recommended extra artifact, the Work Package Portfolio Map (pp. 123-125). Section 6.5 summarizes (pp. 125-126). Leave with this idea: the metamodel says *which entities* exist, the Content Framework says *which work products* use them and in *which ADM phase*. It describes what the architecture should look like when complete (pp. 113, 119). Chapter 6 is part of the GREEN and GOLD reading tours (p. 111).

> **Reading note:** The five purposes and the section-to-phase mapping are the Standard's. Jager's own points are: the placement of driver, goal, objective, and measure in a separate "Motivation" section is "one of the inconsistencies in the TOGAF Standard" (p. 121), and his recommendation to add a **Work Package Portfolio Map** (p. 124). Don't confuse the **Content Framework** (compact, phase-level) with the **Extended Content Framework** (shows the entities per section).

## Detailed Section Breakdown

### Chapter Opener (p. 111)

- **Purpose in one line.** Structure the work products and models that make up the architecture, promote consistent deliverables across ADM phases, provide a checklist of possible deliverables, reduce gaps, and standardize concepts, terms, and deliverables (p. 111).

### 6.1 A Categorization Framework (pp. 111-114)

- **ADM recap.** Eight main phases preceded by a Preliminary Phase, with Requirements Management at the centre. Requirements Management is "not a separate phase, but a mechanism" for continuously testing the architecture. Every phase except Requirements Management describes work products (pp. 111-112).
- **Tailor the Standard.** It should represent the organization in which it is used (p. 112).
- **Three things to define in the Preliminary Phase:**

| # | What to define | Represented by |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Understanding of the types of entities and their relationships | The Enterprise Metamodel (formal model) |
| 2 | A categorization framework for descriptions, work products, and models | The Content Framework |
| 3 | The specific artifacts to develop | Chosen once 1 and 2 exist |

(p. 112)

- **Relation to the metamodel.** The metamodel is a detailed representation of entities. The Content Framework is a high-level summarization, i.e., a categorization framework (p. 113).

| The Content Framework is intended to... | Explanation | Page |
|---|---|---|
| Describe a detailed model of architecture products | They differ per organization, so tailor | p. 113 |
| Promote consistency and coherence of deliverables | The same deliverable is always developed the same way, with entities meaning the same thing | p. 113 |
| Provide a comprehensive checklist of deliverables | Per entity category, what can or should be produced | p. 114 |
| Reduce the risk of gaps in final deliverables | Which models use which entities is decided in advance, provided it is filled in carefully | p. 114 |
| Help use standard concepts, terms, and deliverables | Predefined, defined entities remove ambiguity | p. 114 |

## 6.2 Advantages of the Content Framework (pp. 114-117)

| Aspect | What it means | Page |
|---|---|---|
| Modular structure | Adopt only the relevant parts | p. 115 |
| Core content model | Defines the building blocks and artifacts an effort should produce (actors, processes, applications, data entities, technology components), consistent across the four views | p. 115 |
| Extended content model | Extra depth in areas such as security, governance, data management | p. 115 |
| Architecture artifacts | Catalogs, matrices, diagrams (e.g., Business Process Catalog, Application Portfolio Matrix) aligned to ADM phases | p. 116 |
| Views and viewpoints | Address different stakeholders' concerns. Viewpoints set the conventions for views | p. 116 |
| Agile and digital transformation | Designed to work with DevOps and cloud architecture | p. 116 |
| Guidance for tailoring | Select, adapt, and use the valuable parts. Gives tools and a common vocabulary | p. 116 |
| Outcome-focused | Valuable artifacts that deliver business outcomes, not a rigid structure | p. 117 |

- **Versus previous versions.** More flexible, better integration (e.g., with agile), and more focus on actionable outputs that achieve business objectives (p. 117).

## 6.3 Mapping to the Architecture Development Method (pp. 117-122)

| Content Framework section | What its models capture | ADM phase(s) |
|---|---|---|
| Architecture Principles, Vision, Motivation, and Requirements | Context around formal models: principles, strategic context, requirements. The business context behind the Request for Architecture Work | Preliminary, A (and Requirements) (p. 118) |
| Business Architecture | What motivates the organization, its structure, its capabilities | B (p. 118) |
| Information Systems Architectures | Models of applications and data | C (p. 119) |
| Technology Architecture | Technology assets used to realize IS solutions | D (p. 119) |
| Architecture Realization | Change roadmaps showing transitions between states | E, F, G (p. 119; Figure 6-2 p. 122) |
| Architecture Change Management | Internal and external events affecting the EA, generating action requirements | H (p. 119) |

- **Complement to the ADM.** The Content Framework "describes what the architecture should look like when it is complete" (p. 119).
- **Extended Content Framework (Figure 6-2).** The entities from the Enterprise Metamodel, mapped onto the sections above (p. 120):
  - **Preliminary**: focuses on developing Architecture Principles (much more happens in the phase) (p. 120).
  - **Architecture Requirements**: requirements, constraints, assumptions, gaps, locations, i.e., most General Entities (p. 121).
  - **Architecture Definition**: the most entities, split into Motivation, Business, Information Systems, and Technology Architecture (p. 121).
  - **Architecture Realization**: Opportunities, Solutions, and Migration Planning (one-to-one with E and F; capabilities and work packages) and Implementation Governance. The latter, unusually, uses standards, guidelines, and specifications from the Architecture Repository rather than metamodel entities (p. 122).
  - **Architecture Change Management**: runs top to bottom on the right side (Phase H) (p. 122).

*Jager's commentary (author's view):* Putting driver, goal, objective, and measure in a separate Motivation section, although the metamodel puts them in Business Architecture, is "one of the inconsistencies in the TOGAF Standard". It possibly crept in because many people worked on the Standard (p. 121). He praises the direct link from the Content Framework to the ADM as "very clever" (p. 122).

## 6.4 Tailoring the Content Framework (pp. 123-125)

| When | How the content may change | Page |
|---|---|---|
| Phase A | Initial content set and aligned with business objectives. Additional content or viewpoints may be identified | p. 123 |
| Phases B, C, D | Detailed artifacts may add to or modify Content Framework components | p. 123 |
| Phase H | Managing change may require updated standards, models, or deliverables | p. 123 |
| Throughout the cycle | New insights, stakeholder feedback, or requirements may change the Content Framework and the metamodel | p. 123 |

- **Work packages are underused.** The work package entity appears in both models but the Standard uses it only in the Project Context Diagram (Ch. 12.8.2) (p. 124).
- **Recommendation: Work Package Portfolio Map** (Ch. 14.8). It lists all initiatives and links them to goals and objectives. Useful in Phases E and F as the bridge between business goals and the Architecture Roadmap (p. 124).
- **Living guides.** Iterative ADM execution refines both models as part of governance and development (p. 125).

## 6.5 Summary (pp. 125-126)

- The Content Framework is a categorization framework and "a one-to-one translation of the phases" of the ADM. The Extended form maps all entities, derived from the metamodel, onto the phases (p. 125).
- It is more modular, defines catalogs, matrices, and diagrams, emphasizes views and viewpoints, and supports agile and digital transformation, with a shift toward outcomes (p. 126).

## Key Terms & Definitions

| Term | Definition | Page |
|---|---|---|
| Content Framework | Categorization framework structuring architecture descriptions, work products, and models, mapped to ADM phases | pp. 111, 115 |
| Extended Content Framework | Version of the Content Framework showing the metamodel entities per section/phase | p. 120 |
| Categorization framework | High-level summarization of the metamodel's entities into sections | p. 113 |
| Requirements Management | Not a separate phase but a continuous mechanism for testing the architecture | pp. 111-112 |
| Architecture Realization | Content Framework section for change roadmaps (Phases E-G) | p. 119 |
| View / Viewpoint | A way of looking at the architecture for stakeholders' concerns / the conventions for building views | p. 116 |
| Work Package Portfolio Map | Jager-recommended artifact linking initiatives to goals and objectives | p. 124 |

## Figures & Tables Referenced

| Figure / Table | What it shows | Page |
|---|---|---|
| Figure 6-1 | The Content Framework by ADM phase | p. 118 |
| Figure 6-2 | The Extended Content Framework with entities | p. 120 |

## Self-Check Questions

**Q:** What three things must be defined during the Preliminary Phase when establishing the Architecture Capability?

**A:** The types of entities and relationships (Enterprise Metamodel), a categorization framework (Content Framework), and the specific artifacts to develop (p. 112).

**Q:** List the five purposes of the Content Framework.

**A:** Describe a detailed model of architecture products; promote consistent deliverables; provide a checklist of deliverables; reduce gaps; help use standard concepts, terms, and deliverables (pp. 113-114).

**Q:** How does the Content Framework differ from the Enterprise Metamodel?

**A:** The metamodel is a detailed representation of the organization's entities. The Content Framework is a high-level categorization that structures work products and maps them to ADM phases (p. 113).

**Q:** Which Content Framework section corresponds to Phases F and G?

**A:** Architecture Realization, which holds the change roadmaps (p. 119).

**Q:** Which section of the Extended Content Framework does not take its entities from the metamodel, and where do they come from?

**A:** Implementation Governance. Its standards, guidelines, and specifications come from the Architecture Repository (p. 122).

**Q:** What inconsistency does Jager point out in the Extended Content Framework?

**A:** Driver, goal, objective, and measure sit in a separate Motivation section, even though the metamodel places them in Business Architecture (p. 121).

**Q:** In which phases can the ADM update the Content Framework?

**A:** Phase A, Phases B-D, Phase H, and throughout the cycle when new insights or requirements arise (p. 123).

**Q:** Why does Jager recommend a Work Package Portfolio Map, and in which phases is it used?

**A:** The Standard barely uses the work package entity (only in the Project Context Diagram). The map links all initiatives to goals and objectives and connects them to the Architecture Roadmap. It is used in Phases E and F (p. 124).

**Q:** Why is Requirements Management not described as producing its own work products?

**A:** It is not a separate phase but a continuous mechanism for testing the architecture (pp. 111-112).

**Q:** What is the main shift in the current Content Framework compared to earlier versions?

**A:** A focus on outcomes rather than processes: valuable artifacts that deliver business outcomes instead of a rigid structure (pp. 117, 126).